

China Brewing: Read across from Yanjing: Read across from Yanjing investor meeting: Widening divergence in key SKU performance

We observed a continued structural divergence within the beer industry in 2Q26 (preview here), expecting a c.4% volume decline for Tsingtao/Chongqing and a low-teens% contraction in Bud China, vs. maintained LSD% growth in CR Beer (Exhibit 4). Against a softer macro backdrop for the broader sector, we note that **selected blockbuster SKUs/localized portfolios have continued to show notable resilience**, gaining share through stronger channel penetration/incentives and solid execution. Specifically, CR Beer's Heineken and Yanjing Beer's flagship U8 in the premium/sub-premium segment have consistently outperformed in 2025-2026 YTD. According to Yanjing's recent public investor meeting, U8 has maintained close to 30% volume growth in 1Q26 after reaching c. 0.9mn KL in 2025, while the strategic rollout of the A10 portfolio is gaining early traction after its launch in end-March 2026. Looking into 2H26, we see weather swings/on-trade recovery as the key swing factors, and **we reiterate our positive view on CR Beer** given its beer growth visibility underpinned by a strong portfolio/solid execution, particularly as it moves into a lower base in 2H26, with an attractive risk/reward profile at 11x/10x 2026E/27E P/E and a 5.5% 2026E dividend yield on GSe.

Key takeaways from Yanjing's investor meeting on 16 July: 1) U8 continues to post strong gains in the Rmb8-10 sub-premium segment YTD: U8's sales volume grew nearly 30% and reached 0.9mn KL in 2025 from c.0.1mn KL in 2020 after launch (c.55% CAGR), and the strong momentum has carried over into 1Q26 with close to 30% yoy growth, with momentum accelerating further into July. U8 has been consistently expanding rapidly since its debut in 2019, with a c.30% volume CAGR maintained in 2023-25E, indicating that U8's nationalization/channel penetration are still in their high-growth phases, with the brand continuing to capture market share from competing SKUs in a similar pricing range (e.g., Tsingtao Classic/Snow Draft/Harbin Core+ etc.). **2) The premium portfolio continues to strengthen:** Yanjing has officially launched A10 All-Malt Brew in the Rmb12-15 price range, positioned as the company's core SKU for premiumization in 1Q, and is actively expanding distribution coverage, with additional formats such as canned SKUs/smaller packs for nightlife channels to follow in 2H. **3) The regional portfolio remains resilient despite broader industry softness:** Yanjing's regional flagship Liquan 1998 still delivered YoY volume growth in 1H26, despite severely unfavorable weather in Guangxi in 2Q26. Building on Liquan's proven regional expansion playbook, Yanjing plans to replicate the strategy with Huiquan 1983 this year for expansion in the Fujian/Jiangxi markets.

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Read across to our China Brewer coverage: 1) The sub-premium segment remains the sweet spot amid the consumption slowdown: Yanjing U8 is strategically positioned in the RMB 8–10 retail price segment, which still seems to be the “sweet spot” of China’s beer premiumization due to its mass upgrade path and relatively large addressable market with national scalability, while super-premium beer/craft beers (RMB 12~15+) face distribution bottlenecks and niche appeal. **2) The “Large Single Product” (大单品) strategy remains an effective growth strategy:** Yanjing U8’s success demonstrates that in a mature/flat-volume market, concentrating marketing/channel resources and brand equity into **a single, highly recognizable mid-to-high-end product** is likely still the more efficient way to scale.

Related Reads:

Chongqing Brewery (600132.SS): NDR Takeaways: June saw easing pressure sequentially vs. Apr-May; O2O competition/cost trend to watch

China Resources Beer: APAC Consumer & Leisure Corporate Day 2026 Takeaways - Full year targets maintained with sequentially improved June and intact premiumization; Heineken maintaining 20%+ growth; Reiterate Buy

Budweiser APAC: APAC Consumer & Leisure Corporate Day 2026 Takeaways - Delayed recovery in China; O2O/Premium/new Products remained key growth strategy

Budweiser APAC (1876.HK): 2Q26 Preview: China under pressure with delayed recovery under unfavorable weather/channel mix while Korea recovered on easier comps and India remains strong

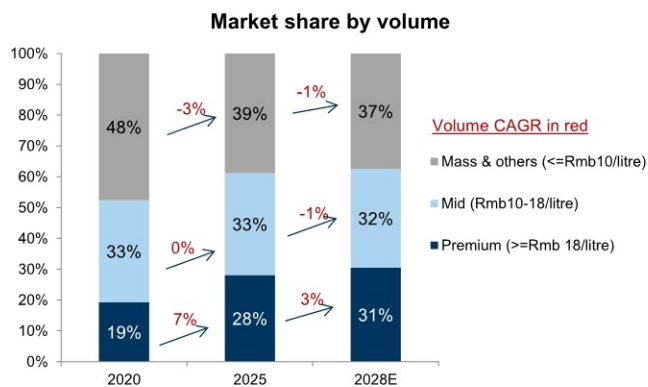
Competition Landscape

Exhibit 1: Premium beer SKU map



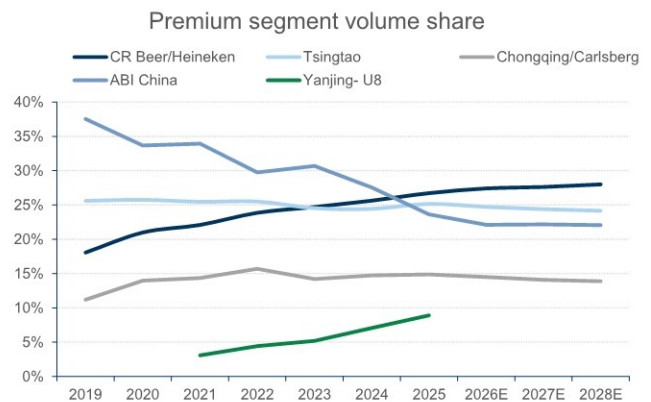
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: We expect premiumization to remain intact in 2025-28E



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: Yanjing significantly gained share in the premium segment over the past five years on U8 success



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

China Brewers 2Q26/2026 earnings forecast summary

Exhibit 4: 2Q26 forecasts in detail – by company/region

2Q26E	ASP growth	Volume growth	Sales growth	Unit COGS growth	GPM YoY Chg	Premium Vol growth	Recurring EBITDA growth	Recurring EBITDA MARGIN	Recurring EBIT growth	Recurring NP growth
CRB - Beer (1H26)	0.8%	3.0%	3.8%	0.5%	0.2pp	7.0%	5.6%	35.7%	7.1%	
CRB - Overall (1H26)			3.4%		-0.4pp		-5.4%	35.0%	6.4%	7.0%
Bud China	-1.0%	-10.0%	-10.9%				-25.0%	31.6%		
Bud West	-0.2%	-6.5%	-6.7%				-20.0%	26.5%		
Bud East	-0.7%	6.2%	5.5%				19.0%	28.5%		
Bud APAC	0.6%	-5.0%	-4.4%		-1.0pp		-13.7%	26.9%	-16.7%	-15.3%
Tsingtao	0.5%	-4.6%	-4.1%	-0.2%	0.4pp	3.0%			-3.6%	-4.7%
Chongqing	0.1%	-4.5%	-4.4%	-1.2%	0.9pp				-4.8%	-4.4%

1) Organic ASP, volume, sales and EBITDA growth for Budweiser excl. forex, but recurring EBIT/reported NP growth under forex impact; 2) GPM for Tsingtao: after sales tax + COGS. Remaining companies GPM after COGS.

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: FY2026 forecasts in detail – by company/region

2026E	ASP growth	Volume growth	Sales growth	Unit COGS growth	GPM YoY Chg	Premium Vol growth	Recurring EBITDA growth	Recurring EBITDA MARGIN	Recurring EBIT growth	Recurring NP growth
CRB - Beer	3.2%	0.1%	3.3%	3.2%	-0.1pp	6.5%	4.0%	26.5%	4.4%	
CRB - Overall			2.8%		-0.1pp		6.2%	26.9%	3.8%	4.3%
Bud China	-0.2%	-1.6%	-1.8%				-9.2%	31.7%		
Bud West	0.7%	0.4%	1.1%				-7.3%	25.2%		
Bud East	0.9%	-0.4%	0.5%				2.0%	30.1%		
Bud APAC	0.7%	0.3%	1.0%		-0.1pp		-5.0%	26.3%	-2.9%	-5.9%
Tsingtao	0.9%	-1.9%	-1.0%	-0.1%	0.6pp	2.0%	2.6%	20.7%	3.4%	1.5%
Chongqing	0.1%	-1.2%	-1.1%	0.6%	-0.1pp	1.1%	-1.4%	25.1%	-2.1%	-1.2%

1) Organic ASP, volume, sales and EBITDA growth for Budweiser excl. forex, but recurring EBIT/reported NP growth under forex impact; 2) GPM for Tsingtao: after sales tax + COGS. Remaining companies GPM after COGS.

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Beer Monthly Tracker

Exhibit 6: Monthly volume table 2024-2026 by GSE

	Jan	Feb	March	April	May	Jun	2025E Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	2026E Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	
CRB	up MSD%		positive growth	positive growth, slightly faster than 1Q	up LSD%	minor positive growth	up 4-5%	up LSD%	up LSD%	slightly positive	flatfish to slightly positive	flatfish	positive	Positive growth ; Jan+Feb Heineken up by DD%	Slightly growth	Up LSD%, similar to 1Q26	slower than April trend	Sequentially faster MoM	
Bud APAC China	down MSD%		decline	down LSD%	down HSD%	down HSD%	down low teens%	down c.Mid teens %	down SD%	Minor decline	Down 7-8%	down DD%	Likely negative	Volume under pressure		up 3-4%	Volume declined by low teens% (super premium up by low teens%, premium down by low teens%, core down by mid teens%)	down 12~13%	HSD% decline
Tsingtao	down MSD%	up MSD%	up DD%	down LSD%	up MSD%	flatfish	flatfish	up 1.5%	up 3%	down HSD%	up 1.1%	up 12%	volume down c.MSD%	down 9.5%		up 5-6%	Volume declined by 7.5%	down 9%	largely flatfish, improving vs. April/May
Chongqing	positive growth		up LSD%	largely steady	flatfish to minor decline	down LSD%	minor decline	down LSD%	up MSD%	Minor decline	up slightly %	up slightly %	Jan-Feb negative on relatively high base	positive growth		Volume down by LSD%	HSD% decline	SD% decline	
Bairun	RTD cocktails down c.10%				RTD cocktail sales down teens%		RTD cocktail down c.high teens%	DD% growth in RTD drinks due to low base	flatfish		offline shipment up 30%		up DD%+ on calendar shift						
Yanjing														SD% positive growth					
Industry	-4.90%	1.90%	4.80%	1.30%	-0.20%	1.90%	-1.80%	3.10%	-1.00%	-5.80%	-8.70%	6.50%	0.20%	-0.10%	-6.20%				

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation Comp

Exhibit 7: China beer coverage valuation comp

Beer	Company	Rating	Ccy	Price	12-m TP	+/-	PE			TP Implied PE			26-28E	26-28E	EV/EBITDA			ROE	Div yield	YTD perf
				7/16/2026			2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	Rev CAGR	NP CAGR	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2026E	%
1876.HK	Budweiser APAC	Buy	HKD	6.49	7.60	17%	18X	16X	14X	21X	19X	17X	4%	12%	6X	5X	5X	6%	5.1%	-14%
0291.HK	China Resources Beer	Buy	HKD	23.74	36.45	54%	11X	10X	10X	17X	16X	15X	2%	7%	6X	5X	4X	17%	5.5%	-9%
0168.HK	Tsingtao Brewery (H)	Buy	HKD	44.92	54.00	20%	12X	11X	10X	14X	13X	12X	2%	6%	6X	6X	5X	14%	6.3%	-8%
600600.SS	Tsingtao Brewery (A)	Neutral	CNY	52.86	58.70	11%	16X	15X	14X	17X	16X	15X	2%	6%	9X	8X	8X	14%	4.6%	-14%
600132.SS	Chongqing Brewery	Neutral	CNY	43.70	43.00	-2%	17X	17X	16X	17X	16X	15X	2%	5%	6X	6X	5X	35%	5.7%	-16%
002568.SZ	Shanghai Baiyun	Neutral	CNY	18.18	18.60	2%	25X	21X	n.a.	25X	22X	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	16X	14X	n.a.	14%	2.0%	-17%
Avg.							16X	15X	13X	19X	17X	15X	3%	6%	8X	7X	5X	17%	4.8%	-13%
ABI.BR	Anheuser-Busch InBev	Buy	EUR	70.72	85.00	20%	18X	16X	14X	22X	19X	17X	3%	0%	10X	10X	9X	11%	1.7%	29%
CARLb.CO	Carlsberg	Buy	DKK	934.80	1100.00	18%	14X	13X	12X	16X	15X	14X	3%	8%	10X	9X	8X	27%	3.3%	12%
HEI.NL.S	Heineken	Buy	EUR	76.64	90.00	17%	14X	13X	12X	17X	16X	15X	3%	6%	8X	8X	8X	14%	2.6%	10%
2503.T	Kirin Holdings	Sell	JPY	2862.50	2400.00	-16%	12X	14X	13X	10X	12X	11X	1%	-7%	9X	9X	9X	12%	2.6%	22%
2587.T	Suntory Beverage & Food Ltd	Buy	JPY	4660.00	5300.00	14%	17X	16X	15X	19X	18X	17X	2%	5%	5X	5X	4X	6%	2.6%	-1%
Avg.							15X	14X	13X	17X	16X	15X	2%	2%	9X	8X	8X	14%	2.6%	14%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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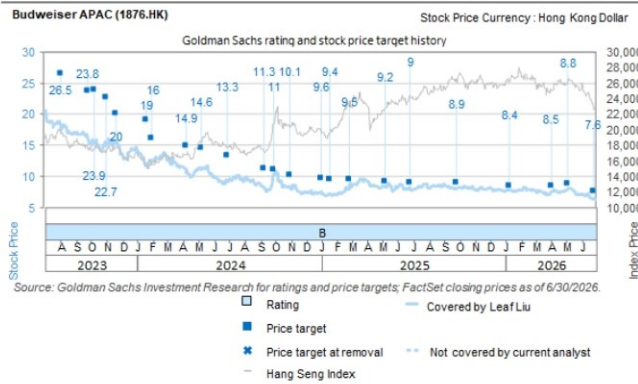
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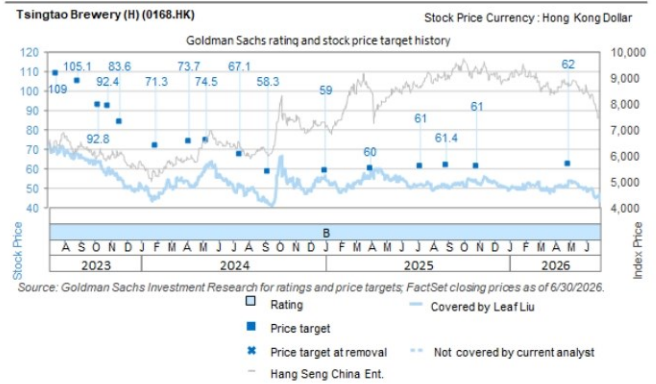
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	Buy	Hold	Sell
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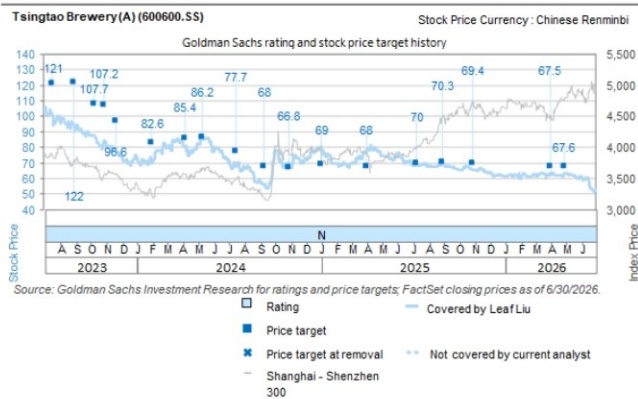
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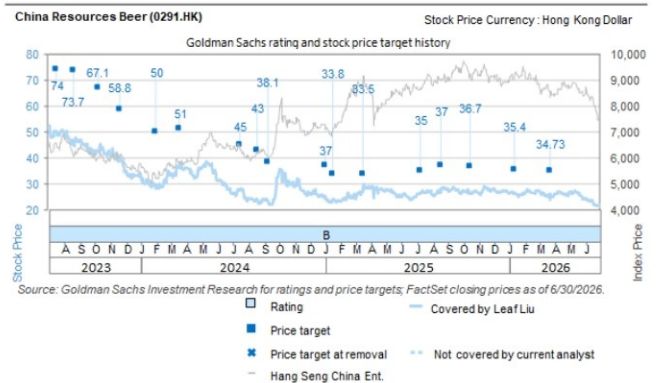
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Target price history table(s)

China Resources Beer (0291.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
10-Jul-26	36.45	22.20
23-Mar-26	34.73	24.02
12-Jan-26	35.40	26.48
15-Oct-25	36.70	26.44
19-Aug-25	37.00	28.28
09-Jul-25	35.00	26.35
18-Mar-25	33.50	28.50
16-Jan-25	33.80	23.65
01-Jan-25	37.00	25.25
10-Sep-24	38.10	22.95
19-Aug-24	43.00	24.00
16-Jul-24	45.00	27.60
18-Mar-24	51.00	37.95

Tsingtao Brewery (H) (0168.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
10-Jul-26	54.00	44.44
28-Apr-26	62.00	52.75
29-Oct-25	61.00	52.85
29-Aug-25	61.40	50.55
09-Jul-25	61.00	52.05
31-Mar-25	60.00	56.00
01-Jan-25	59.00	56.80
10-Sep-24	58.30	41.90
16-Jul-24	67.10	50.60
09-May-24	74.50	61.45
05-Apr-24	73.70	51.40
31-Jan-24	71.30	44.55
21-Nov-23	83.60	54.80

China Resources Beer (0291.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
31-Jan-24	50.00	28.15
21-Nov-23	58.80	39.65
08-Oct-23	67.10	42.95
20-Aug-23	73.70	46.00

Tsingtao Brewery (H) (0168.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
29-Oct-23	92.40	60.25
08-Oct-23	92.80	63.80
28-Aug-23	105.10	66.90

Budweiser APAC (1876.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
26-Jun-26	7.60	6.32
05-May-26	8.80	8.13
02-Apr-26	8.50	7.55
09-Jan-26	8.40	7.78
26-Sep-25	8.90	8.05
26-Jun-25	9.00	8.03
08-May-25	9.20	8.31
26-Feb-25	9.50	8.66
18-Jan-25	9.40	7.19
01-Jan-25	9.60	7.49
31-Oct-24	10.10	8.11
28-Sep-24	11.00	10.14
10-Sep-24	11.30	8.17
28-Jun-24	13.30	9.20
08-May-24	14.60	11.00
07-Apr-24	14.90	11.22
31-Jan-24	16.00	12.28
19-Jan-24	19.00	12.08
21-Nov-23	20.00	15.56
01-Nov-23	22.70	14.96
08-Oct-23	23.90	15.60
25-Sep-23	23.80	16.12
03-Aug-23	26.50	17.50

Tsingtao Brewery (A) (600600.SS)

Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
10-Jul-26	58.70	53.50
28-Apr-26	67.60	63.15
31-Mar-26	67.50	61.86
29-Oct-25	69.40	65.57
29-Aug-25	70.30	69.50
09-Jul-25	70.00	68.92
31-Mar-25	68.00	76.26
01-Jan-25	69.00	80.92
29-Oct-24	66.80	68.51
10-Sep-24	68.00	56.07
16-Jul-24	77.70	67.88
09-May-24	86.20	86.81
05-Apr-24	85.40	80.80
31-Jan-24	82.60	69.66
21-Nov-23	96.60	78.18
29-Oct-23	107.20	84.40
08-Oct-23	107.70	-
28-Aug-23	122.00	94.46

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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